Empowered women, empowered Uttar Pradesh

Reshaping the story of half the population



Since the formation of the government under Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, women's empowerment in Uttar Pradesh has moved beyond policy pronouncements to purposeful, on-ground progress. What has emerged is a comprehensive and carefully constructed framework one that connects safety with dignity, education with opportunity, health with hope, and economic independence with enduring self-worth. Today, the discourse on women's empowerment in the state is no longer confined to slogans; it is substantiated by statistics and strengthened by stories of steady, systemic change.

Economic empowerment: enterprise and independence

At the heart of empowerment lies economic autonomy, and the state has built a formidable foundation through self-help groups. By linking over one crore women to these networks, the government has not only created employment avenues but also enabled sustainable income through micro-enterprises. The Lakhpati Didi initiative stands out as a defining intervention identifying and training women to scale their incomes. As a result, over 18 lakh women have already entered the 'lakhpati' bracket, signalling not just financial growth but a visible shift in social standing. Complementing this, the BC Sakhi scheme has brought rural women into the fold of formal banking. Acting as banking correspondents across villages, they have facilitated transactions exceeding ₹42,000 crore strengthening the rural economy while securing recognition and respect at the grassroots. Initiatives like Vidyut Sakhi have further expanded women's roles, enabling them to manage electricity bill collection and carve out new income streams.

Empower her future

The foundation of empowerment is laid early, and with this vision, the Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana was introduced. Providing financial support from birth through higher education, the scheme has benefited over 27 lakh girls, with more than ₹674 crore directly transferred into their accounts. Delivered in six structured stages, this assistance has not only eased access to education but also helped reshape societal attitudes towards daughters. Parallel awareness efforts under the Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao campaign have further reinforced positive shifts in gender ratios and girls' education. Through the Mukhyamantri Samuhik Vivah Yojana, over five lakh daughters from economically weaker families have been supported in marriage advancing both social security and social equity.

Safety and security: systems that safeguard

Safety remains central to empowerment, and the state has instituted a multi-layered security framework. The 181 Women Helpline stands as a significant support system, offering immediate assistance to women in distress. In 2025-26, achieving a 100 percent resolution rate for all complaints marked a notable administrative accomplishment. Whether addressing domestic violence, dowry harassment, cybercrime, or other crises, the helpline operates round the clock evolving into a trusted touchpoint for women across the state. The Rani Lakshmibai Bal Evam Mahila Samman Kosh provides financial assistance to victims of serious crimes, aiding both justice and rehabilitation. Thousands of women have benefited from compensation worth hundreds of crores, enabling recovery with dignity. Institutionally, reforms have also strengthened representation. The reorganisation of 34 PAC companies and the creation of women's battalions named after iconic figures such as Uda Devi, Jhalkari Bai, and Avanti Bai Lodhi reflect both recognition and resolve. Additional women's battalions are also in the pipeline, signalling sustained commitment.